



Dancing in the sunlight, you might catch a glimpse of the tiny, polka-dotted wonder we know as the ladybug. These little creatures are quite the sight, with their bold red or orange shells covered in black spots. They are tiny, round and have six short legs to scurry around with. And if you look very closely, you might even see their tiny black antennas twitching in the breeze.

From that breeze, our spotted friends might flutter off to their homes. Ladybugs are found all around the world and they live in a variety of places including forests, fields, grasslands and even your own backyard. They love to munch on aphids, mealybugs and other small insects, making them a gardener's best friend. Next time you see a ladybug, remember, it could be on a mission to protect your garden from pests!

Speaking of missions, ladybugs have quite the journey from birth to adulthood. Their life cycle is made up of four stages - egg, larva, pupa and adult. The mother ladybug lays her eggs on a leaf, where they hatch into larvae that look like tiny alligators! These larvae then transform into pupae before emerging as the spotted beauties we know and love.



Just like the brave knights of old, these spotted beauties have their own armor. Their bright colors and spots warn predators that they taste bad, which helps keep them safe. Some types of ladybugs even play dead to trick predators! So, while they might be small, ladybugs are brave little creatures that help keep our gardens healthy and our world a bit more colorful.





Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What color are ladybugs?
A. red B. green C. purple D. blue
- 2) What does a ladybug larva look like?
A. Like caterpillars B. Like little worms
C. Like tiny alligators D. Like small ladybugs
- 3) Where would you most likely find ladybugs living?
A. forests and fields B. oceans and rivers
C. mountaintops D. deserts and caves
- 4) What is the purpose of a ladybug playing dead?
A. To trick predators B. To communicate with other ladybugs
C. To take a nap D. To rest after flying
- 5) Why do ladybugs have bright colors and spots?
A. to blend in with their environment B. to attract mates
C. to warn predators D. for camouflage
- 6) How many legs do ladybugs have?
A. eight B. four C. six D. ten
- 7) What do ladybugs eat?
A. leaves, stems and flowers B. nuts, legumes and seeds
C. worms and slugs D. aphids, mealybugs and small insects
- 8) How many stages are in a ladybug's life cycle?
A. six B. two C. four D. ten
- 9) What are the stages of a ladybug's life cycle?
A. Egg and baby B. Baby and adult
C. Grub, cocoon and adult D. Egg, larva, pupa and adult
- 10) Where does a ladybug lay her eggs?
A. on a leaf B. in a nest C. underwater D. in the air

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I have a bright colored shell! It doesn't just look pretty though, it keeps me safe by warning predators about my bad taste."
- 12) "Gardeners love me because I eat pests that would destroy their plants."
- 13) "I'm small and round with six short legs to skitter across leaves."
- 14) "My mother lays eggs under the ground."
- 15) "From a tiny larva, I become a pupa and then grow into a beautiful adult."
- 16) "I love to eat plants and flowers in the garden."
- 17) "My larvae look like tiny fluffy cats."
- 18) "Sometimes, when I'm in danger, I might play dead to trick my predators."

- 50) It's a myth that the number of spots on a ladybug tells its age.
A. It is
B. It was
C. It has
D. They are
- 51) Ladybugs can't change their spots, just like other animals.
A. do not
B. can
C. cannot
D. will not

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 52) Yuck, ladybugs can release a smelly liquid to scare off predators!
- 53) Share your knowledge about ladybugs with your friends and family.
- 54) Why do ladybugs have bright colors and spots?
- 55) It's amazing how many aphids a ladybug can eat!
- 56) Ladybugs have black spots on their wings.
- 57) What colors can ladybugs be?
- 58) Ladybugs can release a smelly liquid when threatened.
- 59) Where do ladybugs usually live?
- 60) Ladybugs prefer warm, sunny climates.
- 61) Create a safe habitat for ladybugs by planting flowers they like.
- 62) Wow, ladybugs are so helpful to humans!
- 63) Please be gentle with the ladybugs.



Ladybugs

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	A	26.	Not	51.	C
2.	C	27.	Would	52.	exclamatory
3.	A	28.	fact	53.	imperative
4.	A	29.	opinion	54.	interrogative
5.	C	30.	fact	55.	exclamatory
6.	C	31.	opinion	56.	declarative
7.	D	32.	fact	57.	interrogative
8.	C	33.	opinion	58.	declarative
9.	D	34.	fact	59.	interrogative
10.	A	35.	fact	60.	declarative
11.	Would	36.	opinion	61.	imperative
12.	Would	37.	opinion	62.	exclamatory
13.	Would	38.	true	63.	imperative
14.	Not	39.	true		
15.	Would	40.	true		
16.	Not	41.	true		
17.	Not	42.	false		
18.	Would	43.	false		
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Would	45.	false		
21.	Not	46.	false		
22.	Would	47.	B		
23.	Not	48.	A		
24.	Would	49.	D		
25.	Not	50.	A		